

Preston Carey Leslie

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Dear Members of the Assessment, Evaluation & Epidemiology Team,

I am writing to express my enthusiastic interest in the Program Analyst Graduate Internship within the Assessment, Evaluation & Epidemiology (AEE) program. I am currently executing a self-funded, permanent relocation to the Pacific Northwest and am completely free of local commitments, allowing me to establish immediate regional availability for this temporary, 0.40 FTE evaluation term. Having recently earned my Master of Science in Quantitative Methods and Modeling from Baruch College, my professional focus centers on bridging the gap between rigorous data architecture, mixed-methods evaluation, and frontline community health to drive equitable, evidence-informed policy.

The AEE program's mandate to design interactive reports, deploy culturally appropriate qualitative methodologies, and evaluate social determinants of health requires an analyst who respects both statistical software and the human stories behind the datasets. My five years of operational triage within a high-volume, multi-million-dollar community health network (Callen-Lorde) has given me a deep familiarity with the structural vulnerabilities, data governance frameworks (HIPAA/PHI), and institutional barriers that impact public health delivery.

I am exceptionally well-positioned to contribute immediately to your team's active evaluation deliverables:

- **Collaborative Qualitative & Community Engagement:** The core methodology of the AEE program aligns precisely with my community leadership. As the Co-Founder and Event Producer of Queer Roots Cinema, I co-established and managed a community platform explicitly dedicated to fostering intergenerational dialogue, exploration, and structured qualitative discussion among intersectional LGBTQIA+ demographics. Collaborating closely with a board of facilitators, I spearheaded historical film research, digital outreach, and member communications, while working team-wide to curate meeting themes, coordinate crowd management, and formulate targeted, discussion-generating questions. This practical experience navigating group dynamics, balancing collaborative stakeholder input, and centering equity allows me to confidently support your focus groups and community-based needs assessments.
- **Advanced Quantitative and Mixed-Methods Analytics:** While I am deeply grounded in the human element of public health, my background provides a heavy-duty technical toolkit spanning Python, R, and SQL. In my academic portfolio, I engineered an Epidemiological & Social Determinants of Health (SDOH) Analytics Engine that mapped multi-sheet municipal matrices across 141 conformed ZIP code zones, running multi-variable correlation and Poisson regression models. Furthermore, my PEX Project established an automated Statistical NLP workflow utilizing Python and KMeans clustering to programmatically ingest and categorize unstructured text feedback, a computational logic model that directly translates to manual qualitative software pipelines like ATLAS.ti.
- **Systems Triage and Proactive Civic Alignment:** I possess a proven track record of using data to protect public health personnel and optimize resources. When an aggressive expansion at Callen-Lorde threatened frontline capacity, I engineered an ad-hoc tracking infrastructure in Google Sheets that isolated a critical 99-voicemail system capacity ceiling that was silently disrupting patient care. The empirical telemetry I compiled directly justified and shaped a new pilot call center division. Additionally, my proactive acquisition of a Johns Hopkins COVID-19 Contact Tracer Certification reflects my long-term commitment to stepping forward into emergency preparedness and civil service routing.

Though I am a seasoned data practitioner, I possess a genuine desire to learn the formal mechanics of public sector grant writing, and I am eager to apply my quantitative evaluation toolsets to support your division's funding applications and evidence-based reporting.

I welcome the opportunity to discuss how my mixed-methods toolkit can support the Tacoma-Pierce County Health Department. Thank you for your time, consideration, and leadership.

Best regards,

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